Name: CHANDANA L N
Registration number: RA2511056010357
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21LEM202T — Unit 2, Session 2, SLO 1

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Need of the Self or Need of the Body?

For each item, mark whether the deck treats it as a need of the Self or of the Body, and whether the quantity required is limited or undefined.

Item	Self / Body	Limited or Undefined
Food for nurturing the body	**Body**	**Limited**
Food for taste	**Self**	**Undefined**
Clothes for protection	**Body**	**Limited**
Clothes to get respect / be in fashion	**Self**	**Undefined**
Money	**Body**	**Limited**
Continuous happiness	**Self**	**Undefined**

Activity 2 — Spot the gross misunderstanding

Write the three equations that make up the gross misunderstanding, and the consequence the deck draws from it.

- Human Being = **Body**
- Respect = **Physical facility**
- Continuous = **Temporary**
- Consequence: **Unhappiness** and **Confusion**

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Distinguish the need of the Self from the need of the Body in terms of what it is, in time (continuous/temporary), in quantity, and what fulfils it. [5]

The need of the Self is for happiness, peace, and respect—it is qualitative, continuous, and unlimited in quantity, fulfilled by right understanding and right feelings. The need of the Body is for physical facility (food, clothing, shelter)—it is quantitative, temporary, and limited in quantity, fulfilled by material things. The Self's need is continuous and cannot be fully satisfied by any amount of material, while the Body's need is temporary and can be satisfied with a limited amount of material.

Q2. "The need of consciousness cannot be fulfilled by material, and the need of material is fulfilled by material." Explain with the examples of food/taste and respect. [5]

The need of consciousness (Self) is for respect, trust, and affection—these are qualitative and cannot be bought or provided by any amount of material. For example, no amount of money or gifts can guarantee genuine respect from another person; respect comes from right understanding and right behaviour. The need of material (Body) is for physical facility like food—this is fulfilled by material means; for example, hunger is satisfied by eating food, and taste is a physical sensation that can be fulfilled by the right kind of food. Thus, material needs are met by material, but the need of consciousness remains unfulfilled by material alone.

Q3. What is the “gross misunderstanding” about the human being, and what does it lead to? [5]

The gross misunderstanding is to identify the human being only with the Body, and to equate respect with physical facility, and to think that continuous happiness can be achieved through temporary material things. This leads to the consequence of unhappiness and confusion, because the needs of the Self (like respect and happiness) are not fulfilled by material means, and the Body's needs are overemphasized, causing imbalance and dissatisfaction.

Q4. The deck notes that most of our desires turn out to be needs of the Self, yet most of our effort goes into physical facility. Examine your own list of desires and state your conclusion. [5]

Upon examining my own list of desires, I find that most of them are for happiness, respect, trust, and a sense of purpose—these are needs of the Self. However, I notice that I spend most of my time and energy earning money and acquiring physical things, thinking they will bring me happiness. My conclusion is that I have been operating under the gross misunderstanding, and I need to shift my effort towards understanding myself and building right relationships, while ensuring that physical facility is only a means to support the Body, not the source of my happiness.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

- From your desire list, what fraction are needs of the Self versus needs of the Body? (FAQ, Slide 21)
- Trace one example of how money relates to the need of the Body. (FAQ, Slide 17)
- From my desire list, about 80% are needs of the Self (like wanting respect, peace, and happiness) and 20% are needs of the Body (like food, clothing, and shelter).
- Money relates to the need of the Body because it is a medium to procure physical facility—for example, I need money to buy food, pay rent for shelter, and purchase clothing. Without money, I cannot fulfill these basic bodily needs, but money itself does not fulfill the need of the Self.